

THE COUNTRY'S BOOKKEEPER

Come February and the Union Budget and all eyes will be on FM **Nirmala Sitharaman**. Given the current fiscal deficit and government spending, the Budget announcements will be even more significant in 2023. One of the important areas to watch out for is capital gains tax. Currently, there are different holding periods and tax rates for different asset classes when it comes to capital gains. There has been a demand to have one common tax treatment for all capital gains to make it simpler for the ordinary citizen. Will the FM oblige?



POWER RANGERS

In the year ahead, all eyes will be on India's Energy Ministers, **Hardeep Singh Puri** (left) and **Raj Kumar Singh**. As one keeps increasing oil & gas supplies from Russia despite western pressure, another will be focussed on ramping up renewable energy capacity.



MARKET SENTINEL

MADHABI PURI BUCH, the first female Chairperson of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) completes one year at the helm in March. What is on her agenda? First, Sebi will continue to modernise itself in terms of technology and data analytics. Second, it is likely to get rid of the archaic regulations and make them more in sync with the current times.

CAUTIOUSLY OPTIMISTIC

VENTURE CAPITAL FIRMS enter 2023 with a massive pile of capital available and ready to be deployed. Per research firm Preqin, \$534 billion of 'dry powder' was available with VCs globally as of September 2022. While that's good news for start-ups, VCs are expected to move with caution. If liquidity remains scarce, fund managers will slow down on tech investments.

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MITTAL'S METTLE

With the complete buyout of **Essar Steel**, **L.N. Mittal** will need to increase capacity and get a rightful share of the market. Will he make more buyouts and disrupt the market or choose to go for organic growth?